



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

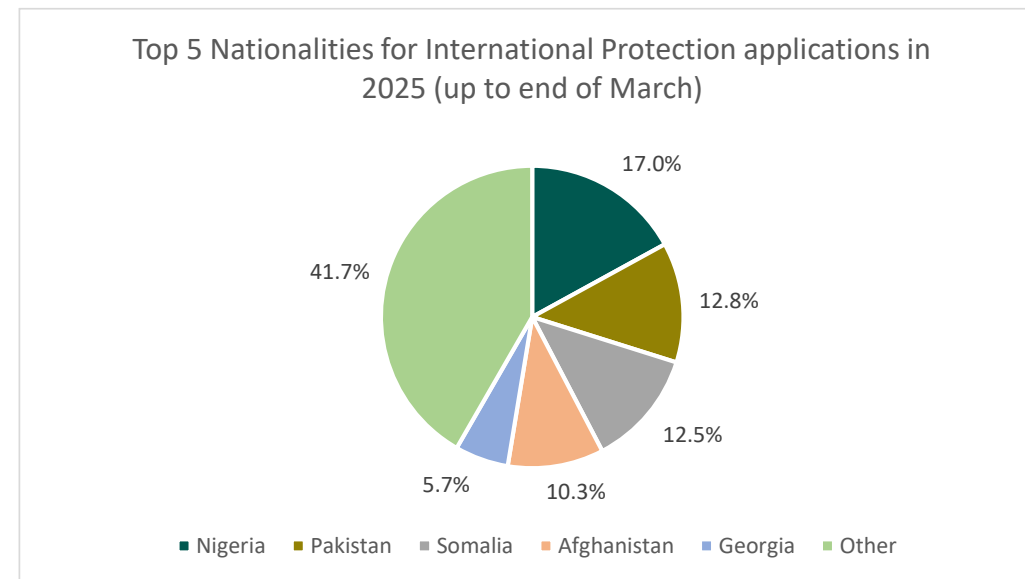
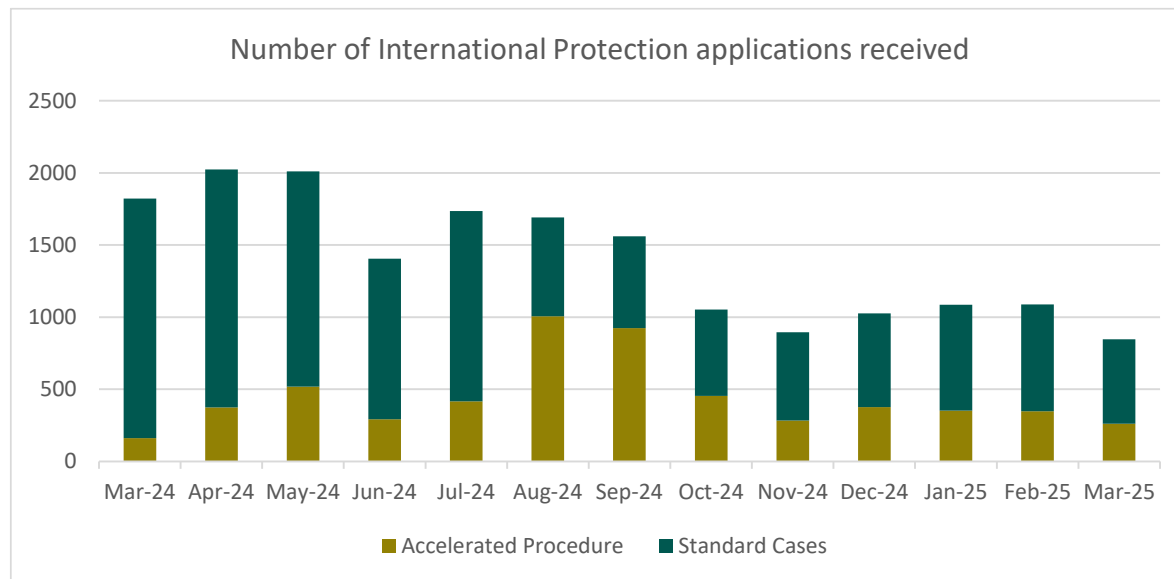
International Protection: March 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 10th April 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for March 2025:

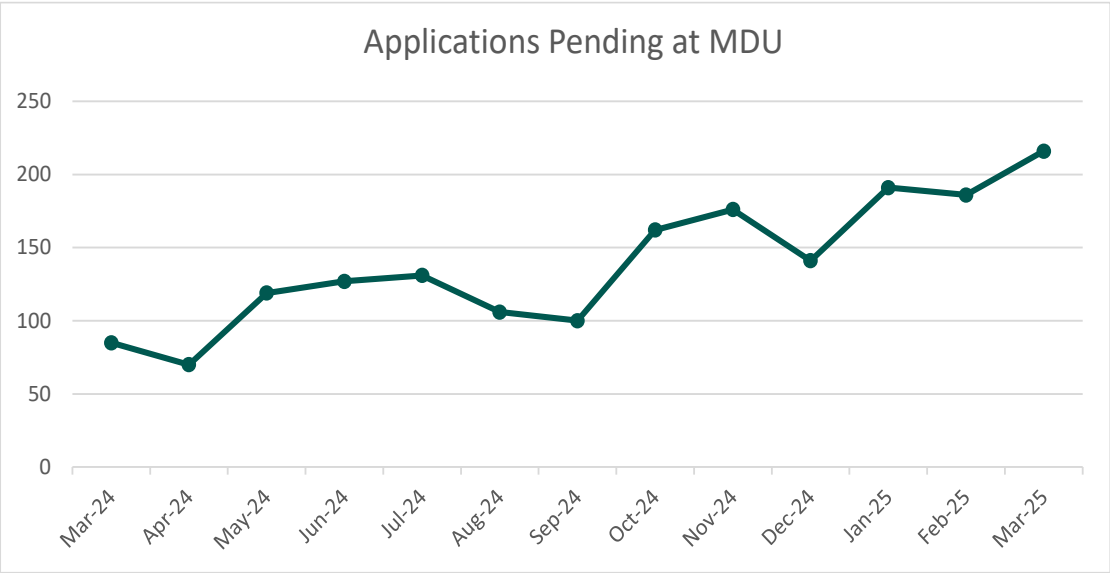
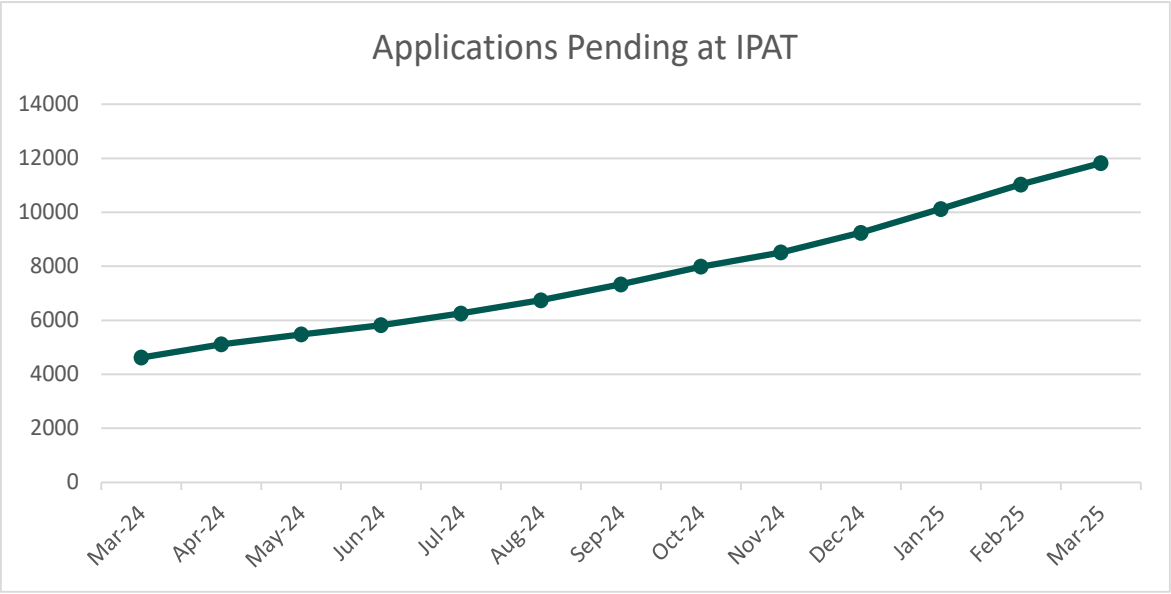
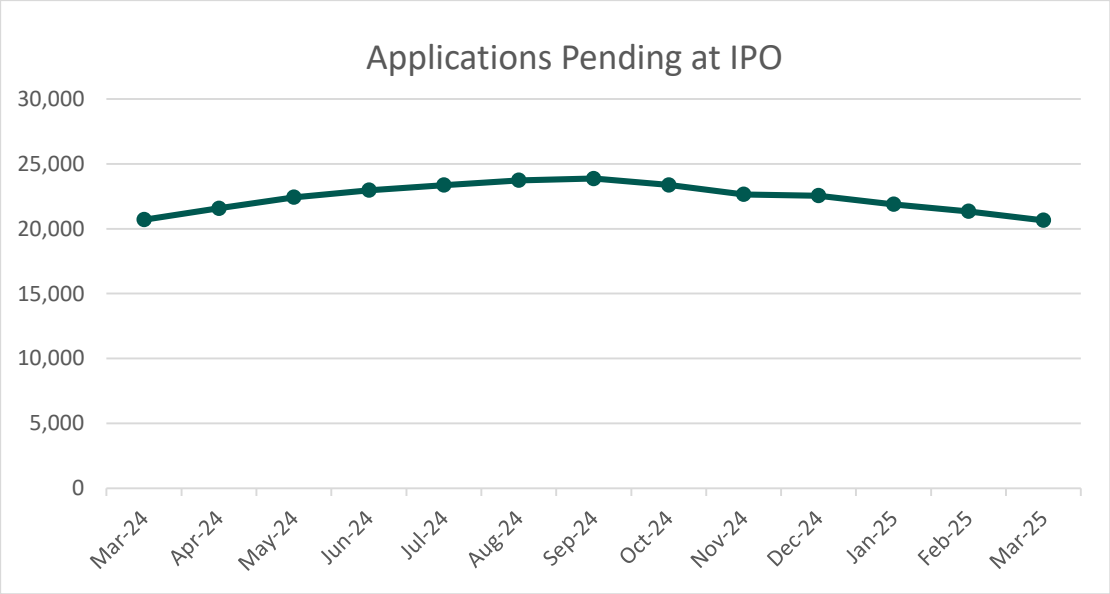
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In March 2025 there were 847 applications compared to 1,821 in March in 2024. For the year to date to March, the total number of applications has dropped from 5,161 down to 3,022, a reduction of 41%.
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (514 applications), Pakistan (388), Somalia (377), Afghanistan (310) and Georgia (173).
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,864. As of March this year, there were 20,655 applications pending.
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In March 2025, 1,522 cases were closed off compared to 869 in March 2024.
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases is beginning to trend downwards. In March 2025, the median processing time to determination was 71 weeks (compared to 79 weeks in September 2024 and 79 weeks in December 2024).
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 607 at the end of March 2025.
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in March 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 51% of decisions were refusals, 3% permission to remain, and 46% were international protection grants.

Applications and Main Nationalities



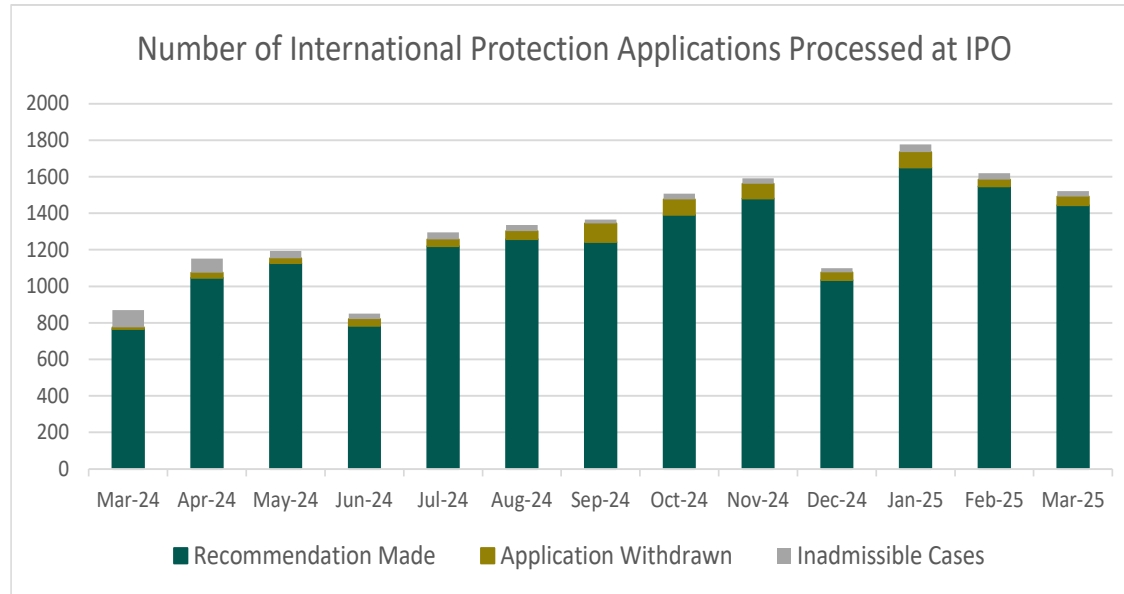
- In March there were 847 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,821 last March.
- The total number of applications in March 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 261 (which represents 31% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Nigeria (514 applications), Pakistan (388), Somalia (377), Afghanistan (310) and Georgia (173)

Pending International Protection Applications

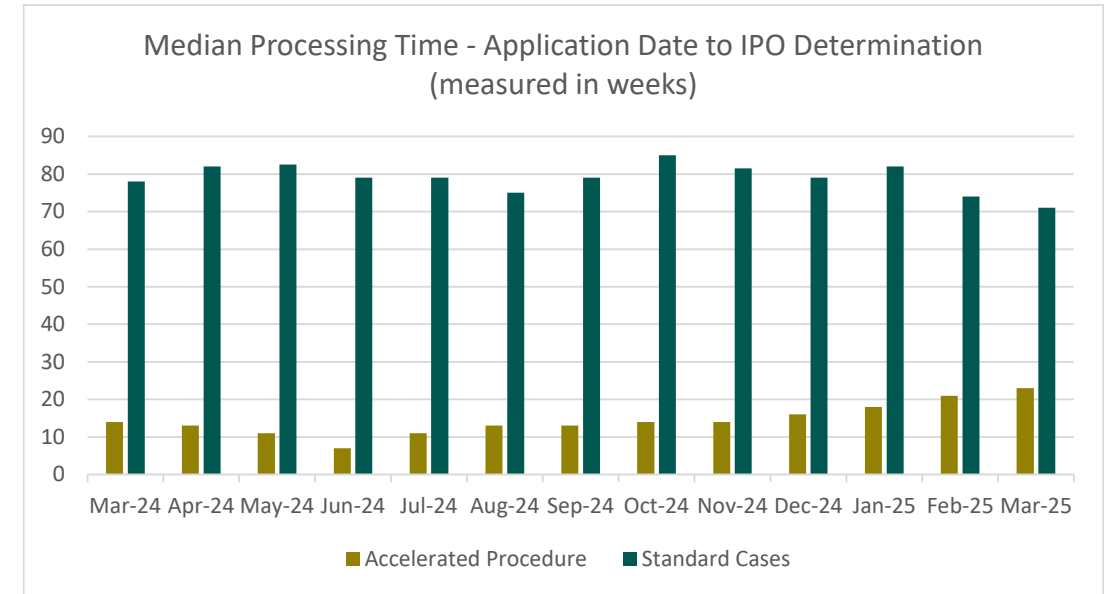


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 20,655. The numbers have begun to reduce since the end of September 2024.
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In March 2025, there were 11,819 applications pending.
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of March 2025 is 216.

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

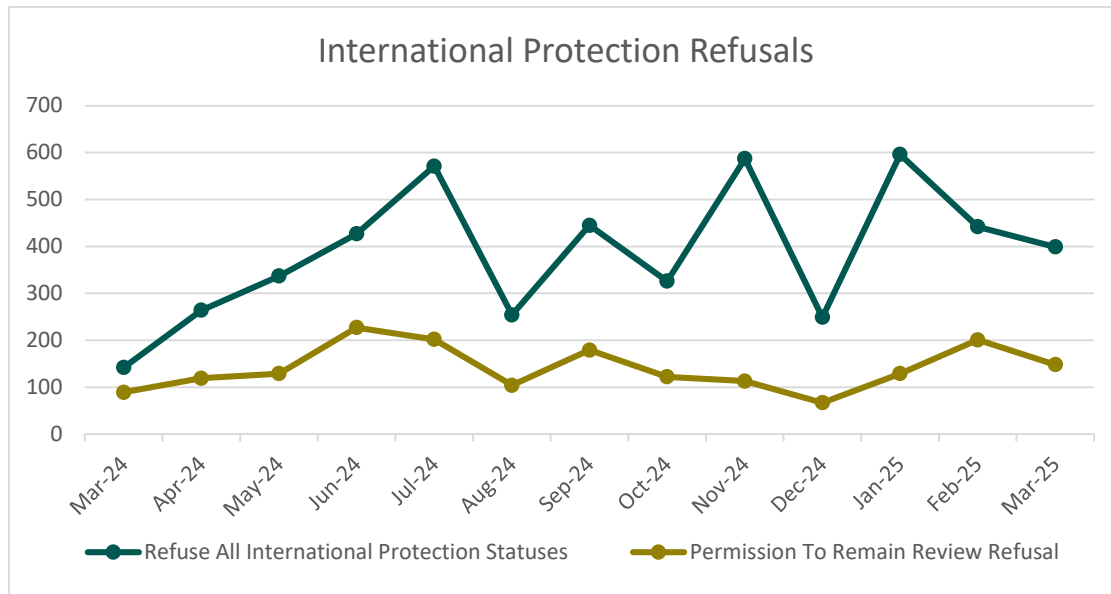
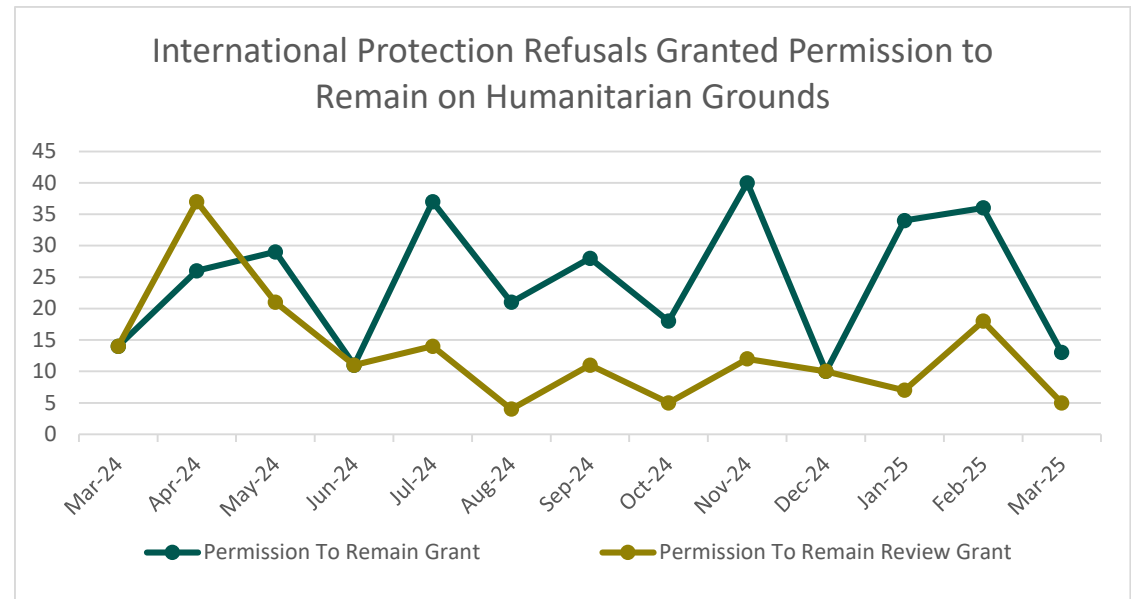
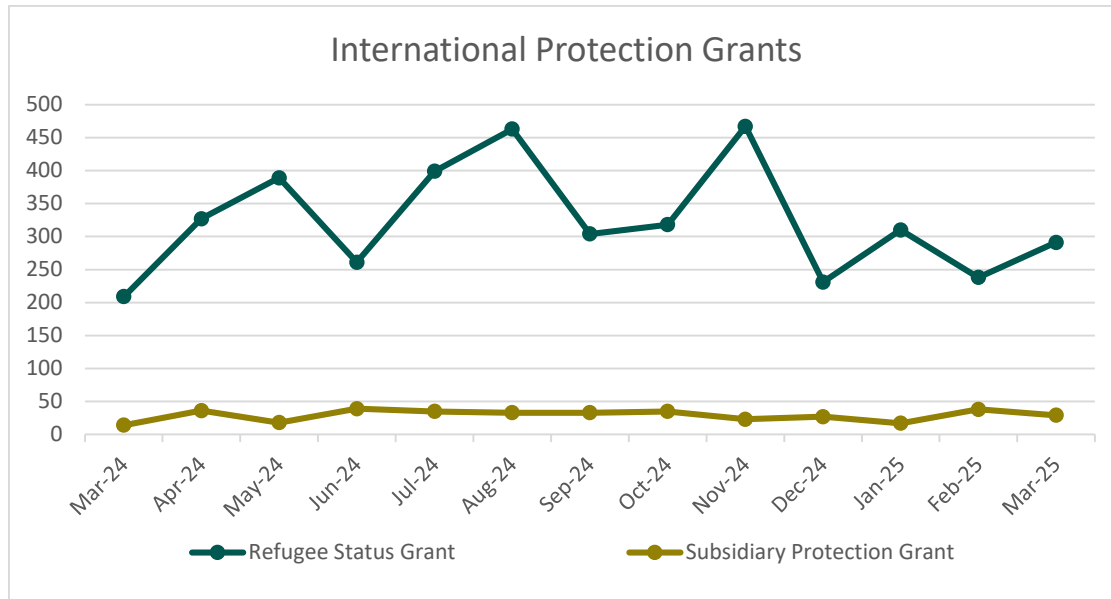


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In March 2025, 1,522 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,777 in January and 1,620 in February
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 4,919 (a 79.7% increase on 2,737 applications processed for 2024 YTD)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly decreasing since October 2024 for Standard Cases and slowly increasing for cases under the Accelerated Procedure
- In March 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 71 weeks (down from 82 weeks for January and 74 weeks for February)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 23 weeks in March 2025, up from 18 weeks in January and 21 weeks in February

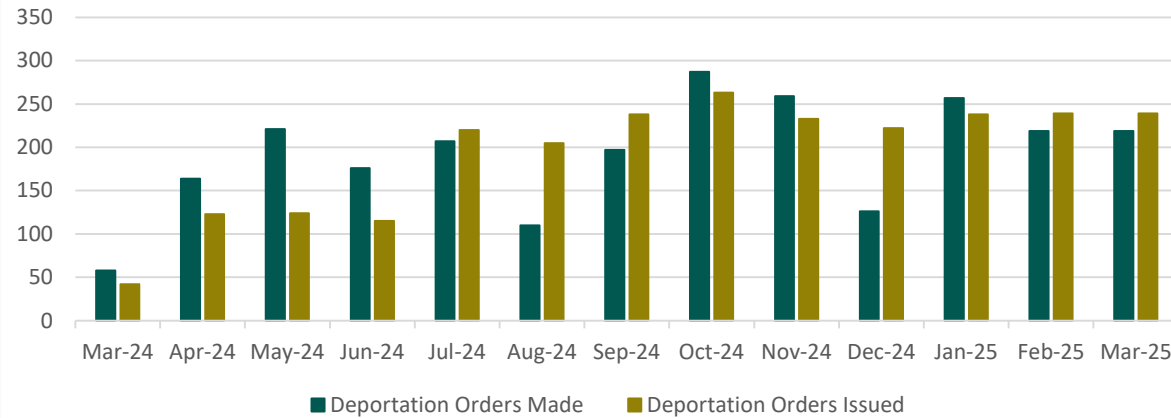
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In March 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 291 were given refugee status grant and 29 subsidiary protection grant (320 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 13 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 5 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 399 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 148 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for March 2025, 51% of decisions were refusals, 3% permission to remain, and 46% were international protection grants

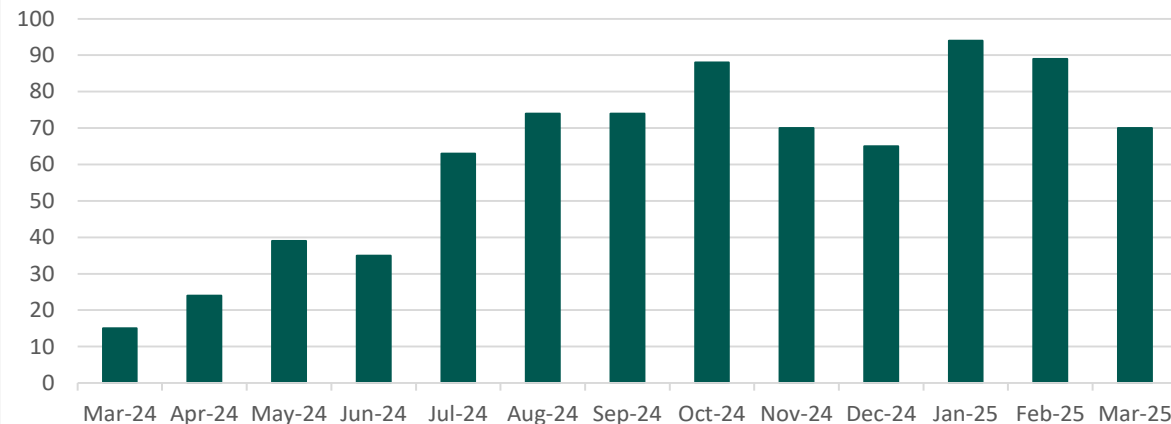
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

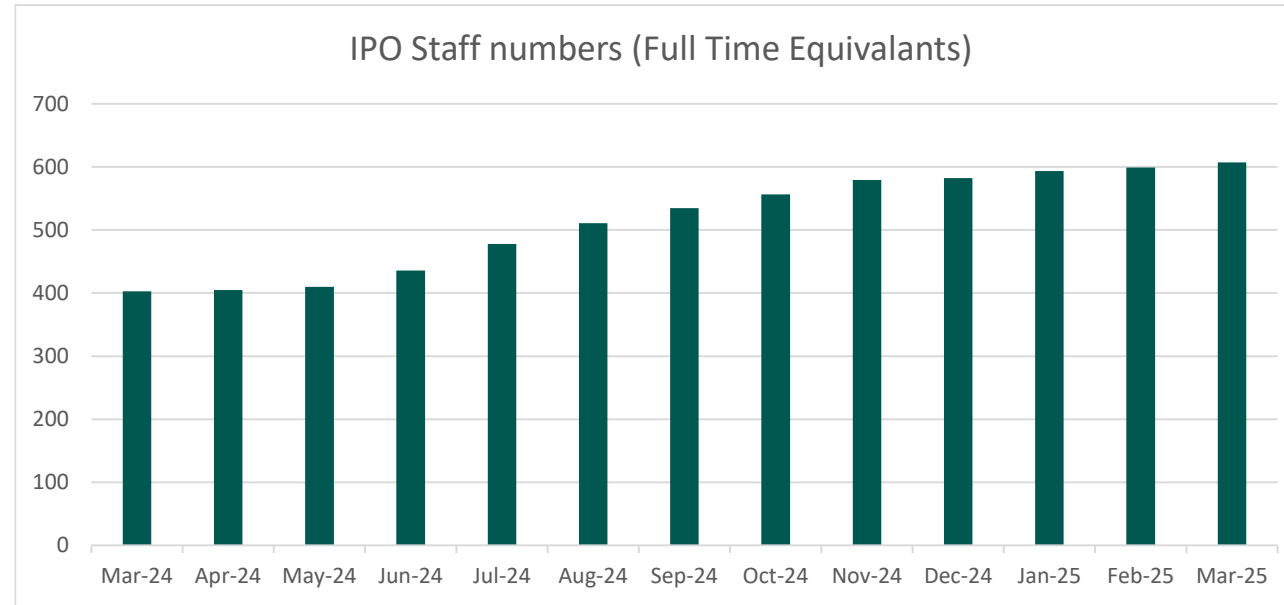


- For March 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 219 and the number of deportation orders issued was 239. For February, the figures were also 219 and 239, and for January, it was 257 and 238, respectively
- For March 2025 the number of removals was 70

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In March 2024 there were 403 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 534 in September 2024 and 582 in December 2024
- At the end of March 2025, the IPO had 607 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

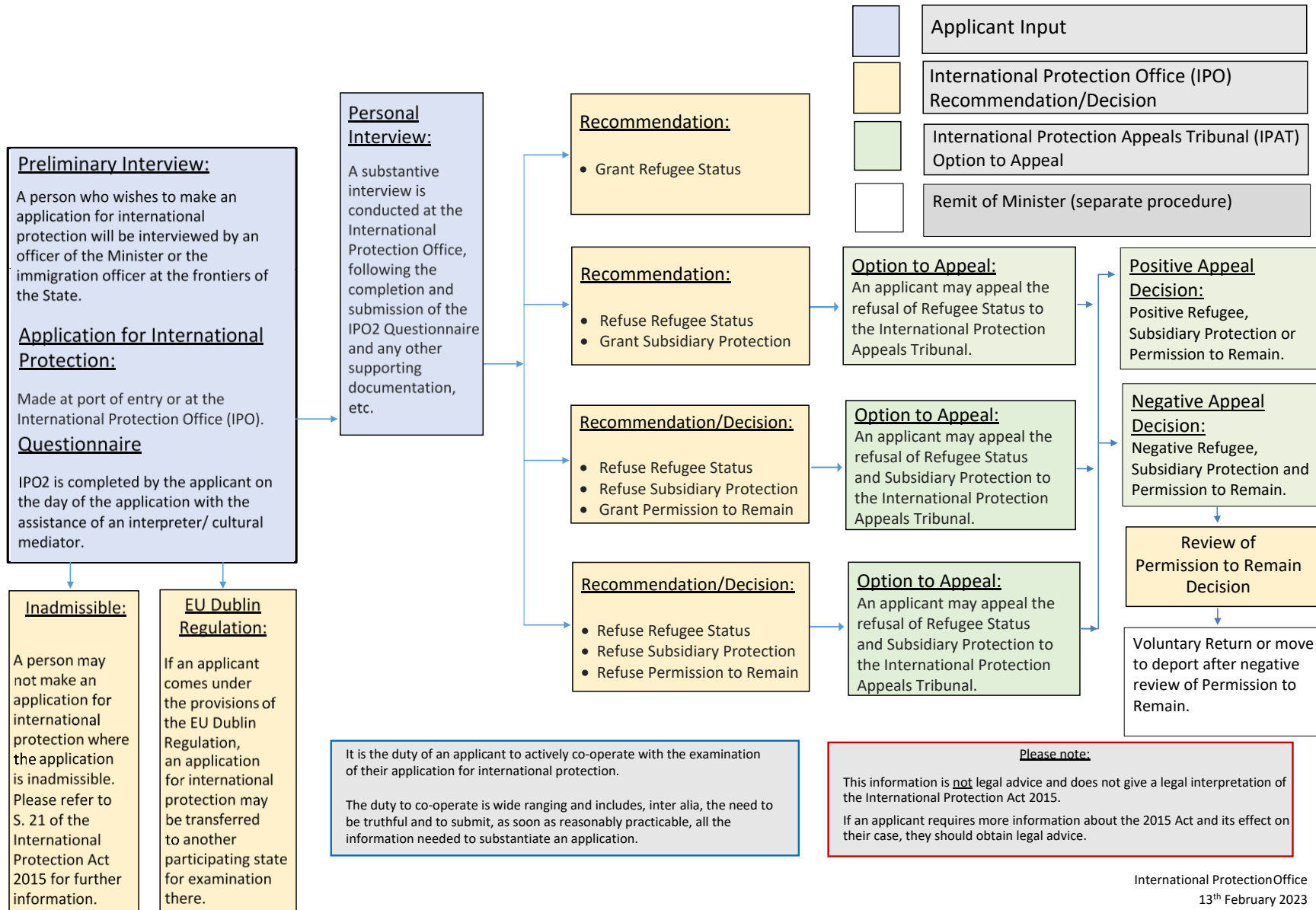
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Accelerated Procedure	162	374	518	292	417	1005	923	453	282	377	351	347	261
Standard Cases	1659	1649	1492	1112	1318	687	637	599	614	648	734	742	586

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	514	17.0%
Pakistan	388	12.8%
Somalia	377	12.5%
Afghanistan	310	10.3%
Georgia	173	5.7%
Other	1259	41.7%
Total	3021	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
IP Pending	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548	21,882	21,343	20,655

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
IPAT Pending	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748	7331	7990	8513	9243	10125	11031	11819

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
MDU Pending	85	70	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141	191	186	216

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Recommendation Made	766	1047	1128	784	1220	1259	1243	1392	1481	1034	1651	1547	1444
Application Withdrawn	10	28	25	36	36	44	101	83	80	43	84	38	47
Inadmissible Cases	93	77	40	30	40	32	21	33	31	22	42	35	31

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Accelerated Procedure	14	13	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16	18	21	23
Standard Cases	78	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81.5	79	82	74	71

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Refugee Status Grant	209	327	389	261	399	463	304	318	467	231	310	238	291
Subsidiary Protection Grant	14	36	18	39	35	33	33	35	23	27	17	38	29
Permission To Remain Grant	14	26	29	11	37	21	28	18	40	10	34	36	13
Permission To Remain Review Grant	14	37	21	11	14	4	11	5	12	10	7	18	5

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	142	264	337	427	571	254	445	326	587	249	596	442	399
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	89	119	129	227	202	104	179	122	113	67	129	201	148

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Deportation Orders Made	58	164	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	126	257	219	219
Deportation Orders Issued	42	123	124	115	220	205	238	263	233	222	238	239	239

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
Enforcements/Returns*	15	24	39	35	63	74	74	88	70	65	94	89	70

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25
IPO Staffing Level	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1	593.4	598.8	607